THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 10 ENGLISH — READING SKILL PAPER SET 04

Reading Comprehension | RBSE Board Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 45 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 20**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Section A has one discursive passage with 10 questions (1 mark each).
3. Section B has one case-based passage with 10 questions (1 mark each).
4. Questions include MCQs and short answers of 30–40 words.
5. Write the question number before each answer.

SECTION — A (Reading Comprehension: Discursive Passage, 400–450 words) 10 Marks

Read the passage and answer the questions.

1. *Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 10

When a little child learns to walk, nobody scolds her for falling. We clap when she stands, laugh when she sits down hard and lift her again. Somewhere between the age of three and the age of thirteen, we change the rules. A fall becomes a disgrace, and the child learns that the safest way never to fail is never to try anything new.

This is a pity, because almost every important discovery has a pile of failures behind it. A scientist who tries a hundred experiments and finds ninety-nine of them wrong has not wasted ninety-nine days; she has found ninety-nine ways that do not work, and is now much closer to the one that does. A cricketer who is out for a duck in the first over learns something about the pitch that a hundred runs would never have taught him.

Schools can do a great deal to restore the child's natural courage. Teachers who write 'good attempt, try this step again' beside a wrong answer give a very different message from those who simply write a cross. Students who are asked to explain their mistakes to the class often discover that others had made the same ones. Parents, too, have a part to play: a father who admits that he failed his driving test twice does more for his child's confidence than a hundred speeches on success. Each of us should remember that the road to a skill is paved with bad first attempts, and that there is no shame in walking it. Perhaps that is why great teachers often tell their pupils the story of their own errors before they teach the lesson. Courage, after all, is not the absence of fear but the habit of trying again in spite of it.

The fear of failure is also catching. Pupils who are frightened of making mistakes stop asking questions, and a class that does not ask questions slowly stops thinking. Teachers sometimes make this worse by praising only the highest marks. A better habit is to ask the child, after every test, 'What did you learn from the questions you got wrong?'

None of this means that failure is pleasant. It hurts, and it is right that it should. But the hurt is useful, like the pain that tells us to take our hand away from a flame. A person who has failed and tried again has something that no examination can award: the knowledge that she can get up.

(i) Why does the writer begin with the example of a child learning to walk? 1

(a) To show that we accept falling then but not later **(b)** To describe a game

(c) To praise parents **(d)** To criticise children

(ii) As children grow older, a fall becomes: 1

(a) a game **(b)** a duty **(c)** a disgrace **(d)** a reward

(iii) According to the writer, the scientist with ninety-nine failed experiments has: 1

(a) wasted her time
(b) found ninety-nine ways that do not work
(c) given up
(d) proved herself wrong

(iv) Pupils who fear mistakes: 1
(a) teach others
(b) score higher
(c) ask more questions
(d) stop asking questions

(v) The hurt of failure is compared to: 1
(a) a holiday
(b) a loud noise
(c) pain that makes us pull our hand from a flame
(d) a gift

(vi) What question does the writer suggest teachers should ask after a test? 1

(vii) What does a cricketer learn from being out for a duck? 1

(viii) What does a person who has failed and tried again gain? 1

(ix) Find a word in the passage which means 'something to be ashamed of'. 1

(x) Find a word in the passage which means 'spreading from one person to another'. 1

SECTION — B (Reading Comprehension: Case-based Passage with data/visual input, 200–250 words) 10 Marks

Read the text and answer the questions.

2. *Read the following poster and answer the questions that follow.* 10

Every year, the Parent-Teacher Association of St. Mary's Public School notices that many students are afraid to answer in class for fear of making mistakes. This year, therefore, the Principal asked the Student Council to plan a week that would change how failure is viewed. The council discussed several ideas for two weeks and finally put up the following poster on the notice board outside the staff room.

The school notice board carried the following poster.

ST. MARY'S PUBLIC SCHOOL — 'TRY AGAIN' WEEK

Venue: Auditorium | Date: 14–18 November 2026 | Time: 11:00 a.m. – 1:00 p.m.

Day 1: Talk by an Olympic athlete | Day 2: Science of mistakes (workshop) | Day 3: 'My biggest failure' – student stories

Day 4: Fun quiz – wrong answers also win marks! | Day 5: Certificates and refreshments

Entry free for students of Classes 8–12. Register with your class teacher by 10 November.

The Council's Secretary added that the school's counsellor would be present on all five days to talk to students who feel anxious about marks. Parents have been invited to attend the final day and to share a story of their own failures. The Principal hopes that this will become a tradition and that students will learn that a wrong answer is only the first step towards the right one.

(i) What is the venue of the programme? 1
(a) Library **(b)** Auditorium **(c)** Classroom **(d)** Playground

(ii) On which day will students tell their own stories? 1
(a) Day 3 **(b)** Day 5 **(c)** Day 1 **(d)** Day 4

(iii) Who can attend the programme? 1
(a) Students of Classes 8–12
(b) Only Class 10
(c) Teachers only
(d) Parents only

(iv) What is the last date for registration? 1

(v) For how many hours does the programme run each day? 1

(vi) Who will speak on the first day? 1

(vii) What is special about the quiz on Day 4? 1

(viii) Why do you think the school chose this theme? 1

(ix) Is there any fee for attending? 1

(x) Find a word in the poster which means 'a place where an event is held'. 1

END OF QUESTION PAPER **Total: 20 Marks**

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